

‘Mate, her confidence is shot.’

The credit confidence crunch

In the last seven years I’ve dealt with hundreds, if not thousands, of young people like Emma.

Here’s what I’ve learned:

Most teenagers don’t have much confidence when they finish high school.

Especially teenage girls. Especially when it comes to money.

So let me tell you what typically happens next.

When you turn 18, the world is waiting to reinforce your belief that you’re no good with money.

Advertisers spend billions of dollars encouraging you to buy stuff you don’t need, to impress people who (you’ll eventually come to understand) don’t really care about you.

Social media makes you feel like a loser if you’re not living an expensive Instagram-filtered life.

But thankfully your bank sees your potential: they’ve decided to entrust you with their precious money, in the form of a credit card. Just like a real adult!

And then, like a drug dealer, they begin upping the limit.

And within a few years your negative beliefs have become a self-fulfilling prophecy:

‘See, I am a loser with money! It must be true! Just look at my credit card statement!’

And then these negative beliefs feed on themselves. They colour your entire life. They keep you stuck in jobs you’ve outgrown, in relationships that aren’t good for you. And life passes you by.

But it doesn’t have to go this way.